



[Infographic] Highlights | Database New Features in August 2026

ApsaraDB

September 23, 2026

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August's verified database releases expand document-scale architecture, lakehouse catalog access, branch-based development, and AI observability across Alibaba Cloud.

August expands the database foundation across document scale, lakehouse access, isolated development, and AI observability. PolarDB for MySQL scales MongoDB-compatible workloads with Limitless multi-master architecture, PolarDB for PostgreSQL unifies metadata across multiple catalogs, AnalyticDB for PostgreSQL brings branch-based workflows to data development, and ApsaraDB for SelectDB strengthens observability for LLM and agent applications. Below is an at-a-glance view of all 10 verified releases, followed by four highlights with the broadest promotional value.

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What's New in Database Products

08/2026

PolarDB

Feature	Type	Descriptions
PolarDB for MySQL Adds Limitless Multi-Master Architecture for MongoDB Compatibility	New Feature	PolarDB for MySQL adds Limitless multi-master architecture to its MongoDB compatibility capabilities. Databases or collections can be sharded across up to 63 read/write nodes, while MongoDB Wire Protocol compatibility supports elastically scalable document workloads. This architecture helps applications migrate smoothly from MongoDB replica sets or sharded clusters to PolarDB.
PolarDB for PostgreSQL Launches LakeBase Catalog	New Feature	PolarDB for PostgreSQL launches LakeBase Catalog to centrally manage metadata from catalogs such as PostgreSQL, Apache Paimon, DuckDB, and Lance. Federated SQL enables queries across catalogs, giving agentic applications and lakehouse analytics a unified entry point for data discovery, access, and governance.
PolarDB for PostgreSQL (Compatible with Oracle) Adds a Structure and Privilege Verification Tool	New Feature	PolarDB for PostgreSQL (Compatible with Oracle) adds a structure and privilege verification tool for post-migration validation. It compares object structures as well as users, roles, and privileges between the Oracle source database and the PolarDB destination, then generates two filterable HTML reports to help teams locate migration discrepancies and complete pre-production checks.

ApsaraDB RDS

Feature	Type	Descriptions
ApsaraDB RDS for PostgreSQL Releases ALIPG 20260830	New Specs/Version	ApsaraDB RDS for PostgreSQL releases ALIPG 20260830. PostgreSQL 18 adds tds_fdw; PostgreSQL 17 and 18 upgrade pg_textsearch; PostgreSQL 18 upgrades Apache AGE; and rds_duckdb adds the all, record, and none automatic table-creation modes for applicable versions. The release expands external data access, text search, graph analytics, and DuckDB integration.

Tair (Redis® OSS-Compatible)

Feature	Type	Descriptions
Tair Adds the France (Paris) Region	New Service	Tair adds the France (Paris) region, giving businesses in Europe another nearby deployment option and helping reduce cross-region access latency.

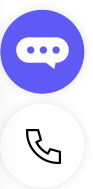
ApsaraDB for ClickHouse

Feature	Type	Descriptions
ApsaraDB for ClickHouse Integrates ClickHouse 26.3 LTS	New Specs/Version	ApsaraDB for ClickHouse Community-compatible Edition 26.3.2.1-1.3.0 integrates ClickHouse Community Edition 26.3 LTS, Paimon, Iceberg, Delta Lake, and intelligent JOIN reordering, materialized view, floating-point compression, and c

ApsaraDB for SelectDB

Feature	Type	Descriptions
ApsaraDB for SelectDB Enhances Kernel Version Upgrades for Greater Transparency	Optimization	ApsaraDB for SelectDB enhances instance kernel version upgrades with pre-upgrade parameter compatibility checks and SQL replay to identify compatibility risks early. The platform orchestrates node upgrades and service switching to reduce manual complexity and provides a standardized path for instances to receive new features, performance improvements, and fixes.
ApsaraDB for SelectDB Enhances DataLens AI Observability with Langfuse Compatibility	Optimization	ApsaraDB for SelectDB DataLens AI provides Langfuse-compatible end-to-end tracing, prompt management, evaluation, and scoring for LLM and agent applications. This update redesigns query capabilities for large projects and adds an exactly-once ingestion pipeline, project-level table isolation, and improvements to evaluation, scoring, and self-hosted deployment, strengthening observability and data reliability for AI applications at scale.

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ApsaraDB for SelectDB Launches AI Assistant	New Feature	ApsaraDB for SelectDB launches AI Assistant, combining product knowledge and best practices with SQL audit logs, execution plans, Query Profiles, and table schemas for multidimensional slow-query analysis. It provides evidence-based root-cause analysis, optimization recommendations, and operational guidance for slow SQL, reducing dependence on manual database diagnostics.
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AnalyticDB for PostgreSQL

Feature	Type	Descriptions
AnalyticDB for PostgreSQL Launches Data Branch Management	New Feature	AnalyticDB for PostgreSQL launches data branch management for pay-as-you-go AnalyticDB Supabase projects. It can quickly create isolated branches with independent runtime environments and connection information, and supports nested branches, branch protection, schema viewing, branch reset, snapshots, and point-in-time recovery. Teams can develop, test, and recover data without affecting the main branch.



New Feature
Product New Features



New Specs/Version
Product New Versions
Product New Specs
New Shapes in Same Version



Optimization
User Experience Enhancement
Function Optimization



New Service
New Service In the Globe
(AZ or Region)



Price Adjustment
Price Changes

Alibaba Cloud | Database

All New Features at a Glance

Product	Feature	Type
PolarDB for MySQL	Limitless Multi-Master Architecture for MongoDB Compatibility	New Feature
PolarDB for PostgreSQL	LakeBase Catalog	
PolarDB for PostgreSQL (Compatible with Oracle)	Structure and Privilege Verification Tool	New Feature
AnalyticDB for PostgreSQL	Data Branch Management	New Feature

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Product	Feature	Type
ApsaraDB RDS for PostgreSQL	AliPG 20260830	New Version
Tair	France (Paris) Region	Region Expansion
ApsaraDB for ClickHouse	ClickHouse 26.3 LTS	New Version
ApsaraDB for SelectDB	More Transparent Kernel Version Upgrades	Enhancement
ApsaraDB for SelectDB	DataLens AI Observability with Langfuse Compatibility	Enhancement
ApsaraDB for SelectDB	AI Assistant	New Feature

Top Highlighted Features

1. PolarDB for MySQL – Limitless Multi-Master Architecture for MongoDB Compatibility

What it is:

PolarDB for MySQL expands its MongoDB compatibility capabilities with Limitless multi-master architecture, allowing databases or collections to be sharded across up to 63 read/write nodes.

Description:

MongoDB-compatible applications can outgrow a single master node and require sharding to distribute data and throughput. PolarDB for MySQL now provides a Limitless architecture that combines horizontal sharding with MongoDB Wire Protocol compatibility, giving document workloads a path to scale on PolarDB while continuing to use standard MongoDB drivers. The architecture can also simplify migration from existing MongoDB replica sets or sharded clusters by reducing application-level protocol changes. Each database or collection has one write-owning node at any given time, so “multi-master” refers to ownership distributed across

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the cluster rather than concurrent writes from multiple nodes to the same collection.

Why developers and enterprises should pay attention:

- **Scale beyond one cluster-wide write owner:** Different databases or collections can be distributed across as many as 63 read/write nodes.
- **Keep familiar MongoDB connectivity:** Standard MongoDB drivers can continue to use the MongoDB Wire Protocol, reducing application refactoring.
- **Create a smoother migration path:** Existing MongoDB replica-set and sharded-cluster workloads can move to PolarDB with fewer protocol-level changes.
- **Consolidate data models:** Teams can place relational and MongoDB-compatible document workloads on the PolarDB platform instead of operating entirely separate database stacks.

Note: This capability is in canary release and requires submitting a ticket to apply for access. A cluster supports up to 63 read/write nodes. Each database or collection has only one write-owning node at any given time. Available regions and versions depend on the approved activation scope.

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2. PolarDB for PostgreSQL — LakeBase Catalog

What it is:

PolarDB for PostgreSQL introduces LakeBase Catalog to centrally manage metadata from PostgreSQL, Apache Paimon, DuckDB, and Lance catalogs and query across them with federated SQL.

Description:

Lakehouse and AI teams often spend significant time maintaining multiple metadata systems, and data is often queried together. LakeBase Catalog provides a unified layer for discovering and accessing heterogeneous data, allowing it to remain in its appropriate system. Federated SQL enables queries across catalogs, reducing the need to create another copy of the data whenever an application needs a combined view. This shared catalog layer gives analytics and AI workloads a clearer path from metadata discovery to governed data access.

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Why developers and enterprises should pay attention:

- **Unify metadata across data systems:** PostgreSQL, Paimon, DuckDB, and Lance catalogs can be managed through one entry point.
- **Reduce unnecessary data movement:** Federated SQL can combine data across catalogs without requiring every workload to begin with another ETL pipeline.
- **Support analytics and AI through the same layer:** Different workloads can discover and access data through a shared catalog experience.
- **Lower integration overhead:** Teams spend less time building custom metadata discovery and connection logic for heterogeneous sources.

Note: LakeBase Catalog is currently in public preview and requires submitting a ticket to apply for access.

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3. AnalyticDB for PostgreSQL — Data Branch Management

What it is:

AnalyticDB for PostgreSQL introduces data branch management for pay-as-you-go AnalyticDB Supabase projects, enabling isolated data environments with independent connection information.

Description:

Development and testing against shared data can introduce contamination, accidental changes, and lengthy environment preparation. Data branch management lets teams create isolated branches without placing the MAIN branch directly in the path of experiments. It supports nested branches, branch protection, schema viewing, branch reset, snapshots, and point-in-time recovery, giving developers multiple ways to create, protect, and restore working data environments. A reset preserves the branch connection information, reducing the need to reconfigure applications after refreshing a branch from its parent.

Why developers and enterprises should pay

- **Isolate development from primary data:** independent branches without directly modifying the MAIN branch.
- **Create environments on demand:** Nested branches make it easier to support parallel features, experiments, and validation workflows.
- **Recover quickly from bad changes:** Snapshots and point-in-time recovery reduce the cost of experimentation and provide a path back to known data states.

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- **Keep application connections stable:** Resetting a branch refreshes its data without changing the connection information used by development tools and applications.

Note: The feature is currently in invitation-only preview. It is free during the preview and does not provide an SLA. The MAIN branch cannot be deleted or reset. A branch reset overwrites rather than merges data and briefly interrupts connections.

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4. ApsaraDB for SelectDB – DataLens AI Observability with Langfuse Compatibility

What it is:

ApsaraDB for SelectDB enhances DataLens AI with Langfuse-compatible end-to-end tracing, prompt management, evaluation, and scoring for LLM and agent applications.

Description:

AI application teams need reliable ways to understand model calls, prompts, traces, evaluations, and scores as projects grow. DataLens AI brings these observability workflows together and is compatible with Langfuse, reducing the friction of instrumenting and analyzing LLM and agent behavior. This update redesigns query capabilities for large projects and adds an exactly-once ingestion pipeline, project-level table isolation, and improvements to evaluation, scoring, and self-hosted deployment. The result is a more reliable observability data path and clearer separation between projects at scale.

Why developers and enterprises should pay attention:

- **Trace AI workflows end to end:** Teams can inspect LLM and agent execution paths instead of troubleshooting.
- **Manage prompts and quality signals together:** Evaluation, and scoring share one observability data path.
- **Improve observability data reliability:** The exactly-once ingestion pipeline reduces duplicate or inconsistent trace data.
- **Support larger teams and projects:** Project-level table isolation and large-project query improvements create clearer operational boundaries as usage grows.

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Note: DataLens AI is currently in invitation-only preview.

Other Notable Updates

PolarDB for PostgreSQL (Compatible with Oracle) — Structure and Privilege Verification Tool

PolarDB for PostgreSQL (Compatible with Oracle) adds a post-migration verification tool that compares object structures as well as users, roles, and privileges between an Oracle source database and the PolarDB destination. Two filterable HTML reports help migration teams locate discrepancies before production cutover. The tool performs comparisons only; it does not migrate data or automatically repair differences.

Note: The runtime environment requires Java 1.8 or later, connectivity to both databases, and an execution account with permission to read the required metadata.

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ApsaraDB RDS for PostgreSQL — AliPG 20260830

ApsaraDB RDS for PostgreSQL releases AliPG 20260830 with broader extension capabilities. PostgreSQL 18 adds `tds_fdw`, PostgreSQL 17 and 18 upgrade `pg_textsearch`, PostgreSQL 18 upgrades Apache AGE, and `rds_duckdb` adds the `all`, `record`, and `none` automatic table-creation modes for applicable versions. These changes expand external data access, text search, graph analytics, and DuckDB-based analysis.

Note: Extension availability depends on the PostgreSQL major version, instance minor engine version, and regional rollout. Applicable versions for `rds_duckdb` are subject to the console and e

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Tair — France (Paris) Region

Tair adds the France (Paris) region, giving European workloads another nearby deployment option and helping reduce cross-region access latency. The expansion also gives organizations another location to consider when planning a multi-region caching or in-memory database footprint in Europe.

Note: Released on August 21, 2026. The region supports cloud-native instances only and does not support classic instances. Available

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ApsaraDB for ClickHouse — ClickHouse 26.3 LTS

ApsaraDB for ClickHouse Community-compatible Edition 26.3.2.1-1.3.0 integrates ClickHouse Community Edition 26.3 LTS (v26.3.17.4-lts). The release expands access to Paimon, Iceberg, Delta Lake, and Hudi and adds inverted indexes, intelligent JOIN reordering, materialized CTEs, Bucketed Map, vertical merge for TTL, ALP floating-point compression, and compatibility with multiple SQL dialects. It gives analytical workloads more options to query lake data, optimize joins, and reduce migration rewrites.

Note: Paimon currently supports read access only.

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ApsaraDB for SelectDB — More Transparent Kernel Version Upgrades

ApsaraDB for SelectDB enhances kernel version upgrades with pre-upgrade parameter compatibility checks and SQL replay to surface risks early. The platform then orchestrates node upgrades and service switching, providing a standardized path to new features, performance improvements, and fixes with less manual coordination.

Note: Brief connection interruptions may occur. A major-version upgrade may cause approximately 10 minutes of downtime, while a parallel upgrade may cause approximately 1 to 5 minutes. Rollback is not supported after an upgrade starts, and other instance lifecycle operations are unavailable during the upgrade. Business impact and retry mechanisms must be evaluated in advance.

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ApsaraDB for SelectDB — AI Assistant

ApsaraDB for SelectDB introduces AI Assistant to analyze slow SQL by combining product knowledge with SQL audit logs, execution plans, Query Profiles, and table schemas. It provides evidence-based root-cause analysis, optimization recommendations, and operational guidance, shortening the path from a slow-query alert to a concrete tuning action.

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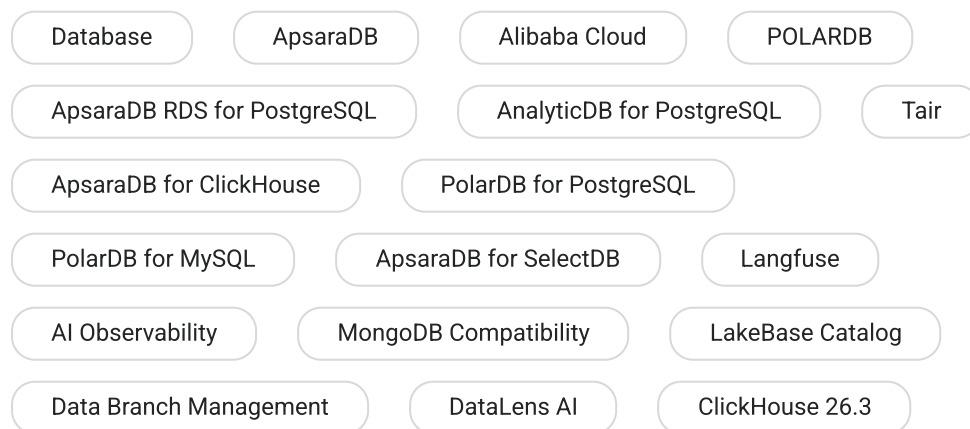
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Looking Ahead

August's verified releases strengthen the database foundation from several directions at once: document workloads gain a path to horizontal scale, lakehouse data becomes easier to discover and query together, development teams gain safer data isolation, and AI applications gain deeper observability. The same release set also improves migration validation, engine capabilities, upgrade workflows, diagnostics, and regional coverage. Follow the next monthly roundup for more updates across the Alibaba Cloud database portfolio.

Learn more about Alibaba Cloud Database services: [ApsaraDB Product Page](#)



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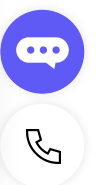
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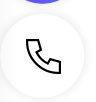
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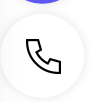
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